

Heads Up!

EDITION 36 · SEPTEMBER 2026 · IIH AWARENESS MONTH

Heads Up! is back, and it looks different. We have had no newsletter volunteer since the end of last year, so we have used the gap to rebuild it for how most of you read — on a phone, in short bursts.



CONFERENCE · BOOKING OPEN

June 2027 is open

WHEN

Sat 12 June 2027

WHERE

Village Hotel, Solihull

TICKETS

£25

A full day, 9am to 5pm, of lived experience, current treatment and research, and space for honest questions. The £25 is subsidised by IIH UK and includes all

refreshments and lunch.

You need to be an IIH UK member to come. Not a member yet? Join first, then book — membership starts at £5 a year for one person, or £10 for a family.

Anyone 14 and over needs a ticket. Under-13s are free, but let Betsy know they are coming at treasurer@iih.org.uk .

[Join IIH UK](#) 

[Then book your place](#) 

 Opens another website

 Opens your email

EVERY EDITION • MEMBERSHIP

Join or renew

Renewals are due this autumn, and membership is what gets you into the conference.

[Join or renew](#) 



RESEARCH

What is happening in IIH research

LEAD

BETTER CARE FOR IIH

A call for new standards of care

IIH UK is delighted to be talking with orthoptist Daisy MacKeith, who spoke at our conference about the need for updated guidance in IIH. Daisy and colleagues have set out their call for new standards of care in the journal *Eye*. We will share more as soon as we have any updates.

[Read the RISE-IIH paper](#) 

WORTH KNOWING

RESEARCH

The research that reaches space

Astronauts can develop eye and pressure changes that look like IIH. So the Birmingham team led by Professor Alex Sinclair now works with NASA — and what is learned in orbit feeds back into IIH care.

[Read the Birmingham story](#) 

Also: Amanda and Clare, both IIH UK trustees, are excited to be working with an international team of researchers on developing new guidelines for IIH. We will share more with you as soon as we are able.



FUNDRAISING

Raising money for IIH UK

Happening now — you can support these

VIRTUAL WALK

Debbie walks Land's End to John O'Groats

Debbie Cope is walking the whole length of Britain — virtually — to raise money and awareness for IIH UK. She has walked 771 miles, with 103 to go.

Every mile is a reminder that living with IIH can be unpredictable, but I am determined to finish what I started. I have come far too far to stop now!

DEBBIE COPE

[Support Debbie](#)



Fig, handmade by Blue Doe Bears

AWARENESS MONTH • CLOSING 30 SEPTEMBER

Win a handmade prize in our raffle

Tickets are £1 each. Prizes include handmade crafts, gift vouchers and a collectible teddy bear, all given by our supporters. The draw closes on 30 September.

[Buy a raffle ticket](#)

Thank you — money already raised

HALF MARATHON

Andrew, Ryan and Ethan at Lake Vyrnwy

Thank you to Andrew, Ryan and Ethan, who ran the Lake Vyrnwy Half Marathon on 13 September for Andrew's wife Kirsty, who has IIH. So far they have raised £885, plus Gift Aid, from 28 supporters.

[See their page](#) 

DONATION

£5,000 from the Card Factory Foundation

A huge thank you to the Card Factory Foundation for its donation of £5,000, and to Nicky Butler, who works at her local Card Factory store and nominated IIH UK.

EVERY EDITION • EASY WAYS TO HELP

Raise money without spending more

Shop online through easyfundraising and the shop gives IIH UK a donation, at no cost to you. Or give once, straight to the charity.

[easyfundraising](#) 

[Donate](#) 



EVENTS

Where IIH UK has been, and is going

Coming up



EARLY OCTOBER • LONDON

Talking to doctors at the Headache Masterclass

In early October the IIH UK team will be at the Headache Academy's teaching event in London, sharing information about IIH with doctors and other health professionals.

Shelly with Professor Alex Sinclair at the Headache Academy in 2024.

[Headache Academy](#)

What happened — our June conference in pictures



Speakers taking questions from the room



Listening to the talks



Catching up round the table



Working through a session together



In the audience



The IIH UK information stand



Community time after the conference (from the IIH UK Facebook page)

Photographs by [Daniella Mills Photography](#) [↗](#)



SPOTLIGHT

The people behind IIH UK

NEW TO THE TEAM

Welcome, Daniella, Dan and Debbie



Daniella Mills

IIH UK photographer

"Based in North Devon. You'll often see me at IIH UK events with a camera in hand."



Dan Boyland

Volunteer, digital design

"Hi, I'm Dan. I design digital learning, and I built our new online tools and this newsletter."



Debbie Cope

Volunteer

"Hi, I'm Debbie. I'm a dance teacher, and I'm proud to be part of IIH UK so that nobody has to face their IIH journey alone."

MEET THE TEAM

Could you be next?

Each edition we introduce one person — a volunteer, a HOPE facilitator, or a clinician or researcher working on IIH.

[Meet the whole team](#) 

EVERY EDITION • GET INVOLVED

Where we are short

- Newsletter editor
- Social media
- Events and fundraising

All from home, around your own health. Email us and we will tell you what is involved.

info@iih.org.uk ✉

secretary@iih.org.uk ✉



PROGRAMME UPDATE

HOPE and our new tools

RUNNING NOW

HOPE PROGRAMME

The autumn course has started

The Hope Programme for IIH is a free six-session online course, created with IIH UK, people living with IIH and healthcare professionals. The current course began on 16 September.

A 2026 evaluation of 454 people across 11 courses found promising improvements in mental wellbeing. IIH UK funded this evaluation through one of its 2024 research grants to HOPE CIC.

We will update you when the next HOPE programme date is finalised.

I think it's in the name. It helps you build that hope back. Like, still do things that maybe you did do before, just in a different way.

HOPE PARTICIPANT

It's meaning that I can stay at work, using the techniques. I don't think I'd be where I am today if I hadn't done the HOPE course. It's helped me come to terms with what I've got, and learning how to live with it. And not letting it rule my life.

HOPE PARTICIPANT

I think it helped inspire me to start taking a positive approach to controlling my situation as much as I can, and therefore ultimately led to me being in remission.

HOPE PARTICIPANT

From the research Professor Andy Turner presented at our June conference.

[Read the report \(PDF\)](#) 

[About HOPE](#) 

YOUR VIEW WANTED

RESOURCES

Four new tools, not finished yet

What is IIH?, Family friends and carers, the Resource Hub and the Consensus Guidelines tool now work on any device. Before we call them done, we want to hear from you.

[Try them and tell us](#) 

Where to get more help and support



IIH UK — information, leaflets
and support



IIH UK on Facebook (official
page)



IIH UK on Instagram



IIH UK on TikTok



Watch IIH UK on YouTube



Email IIH UK — info@iih.org.uk



Nothing in this newsletter is medical advice. Always speak to your own clinical team about your care.

THIS EDITION

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